

Copycat Olive Garden's Chicken & Gnocchi Soup

This comforting copycat Olive Garden chicken and gnocchi soup is creamy, with chewy, pillowy gnocchi to satisfy your appetite. Enjoy with a green salad and breadsticks for dipping.

By **Julia Levy** | Updated on January 23, 2026

 Reviewed by Dietitian **Christa Brown, M.S., RDN, LD**

Active Time: 45 mins

Total Time: 45 mins

Servings: 4

Nutrition Profile:

Diabetes-Friendly Nut-Free Soy-Free High-Protein Egg-Free Gluten-Free

Ingredients

3 tablespoons extra-virgin olive oil

1½ cups chopped yellow onion

¾ cup sliced celery

2 tablespoons minced garlic

2 teaspoons fresh thyme leaves

5 cups lower-sodium chicken broth

¾ cup matchstick carrots

½ teaspoon ground pepper

⅛ teaspoon salt

1 (14 ounce) bone-in chicken breast, skin removed

1 (12 ounce) package refrigerated potato gnocchi

3 cups baby spinach, coarsely chopped

½ cup half-and-half

2 tablespoons cornstarch

Directions

Step 1

Heat 3 tablespoons oil in a large Dutch oven over medium heat. Add 1½ cups onion and ¾ cup celery; cook, stirring occasionally, until softened, about 5 minutes. Stir in 2 tablespoons garlic and 2 teaspoons thyme; cook, stirring often, until fragrant, about 1 minute. Stir in 5 cups broth, ¾ cup carrots, ½ teaspoon pepper, ½ teaspoon salt and 14 ounces chicken; bring to a boil over medium-high heat. Reduce heat to medium to maintain a simmer; cook, flipping the chicken occasionally, until an instant-read thermometer inserted into the thickest part of the chicken registers 165°F, 15 to 20 minutes. Transfer the chicken to a plate.

Step 2

Stir 12 ounces gnocchi into the simmering soup; cook, stirring occasionally, until tender, about 5 minutes. Meanwhile, using 2 forks, shred the chicken into bite-size pieces. Return the shredded chicken to the pot. Add 3 cups spinach; stir until the spinach is wilted, about 1 minute.

Step 3

Whisk ½ cup half-and-half and 2 tablespoons cornstarch together in a liquid measuring cup. Drizzle the mixture into the soup; cook, stirring constantly, until slightly thickened, about 2 minutes.

Frequently Asked Questions

Is there a difference between refrigerated gnocchi vs. shelf-stable?

Yes, there is a difference. When our recipes call for refrigerated gnocchi, we do so because it offers a fresh flavor and a delicate, soft texture that won't easily become gummy. We choose shelf-stable gnocchi when we want a firmer, denser texture that can better withstand specific cooking methods.

Is there a difference between baby spinach vs. mature leaf spinach?

We chose baby spinach for this soup because the leaves are mild, tender and smaller in size. This makes it the best option for this recipe. Additionally, baby spinach contains less oxalic acid, which may be a concern for some. In contrast, mature spinach leaves have a stronger flavor and are better suited for recipes that require longer cooking times.

How should I store and reheat leftovers?

While enjoying this soup freshly cooked is the best option, it can be stored in the fridge for about 3 days. Just make sure it's completely cool before placing it in an airtight container. If you make a double batch, you can freeze it for up to 3 months, though the texture may change. We recommend reheating the soup over medium heat on the stovetop until it reaches your desired temperature. Alternatively, you can microwave it in 30-second intervals, stirring in between. If the soup is a bit thick after sitting, feel free to add a splash of water.

What should I serve with Copycat Olive Garden's Chicken & Gnocchi Soup?

A freshly made green salad is ideal like our Basic Green Salad with Vinaigrette or one of our other favorite salads like a cacio e pepe kale salad, Kale & Strawberry Salad or Raspberry-Spinach Salad with Avocado & Walnuts, and you'll probably want dinner rolls, cornbread or breadsticks to mop up any delicious remnants of broth.

EatingWell.com, December 2022

Nutrition Facts

Per serving: **Serving Size 2 cups** 451 calories; total fat 17g; saturated fat 4g; cholesterol 58mg; sodium 574mg; total carbohydrate 49g; dietary fiber 5g; total sugars 5g; added sugars 0g; protein 27g; vitamin c 20mg; calcium 151mg; iron 3mg; potassium 673mg

Additional reporting by Carrie Myers, M.S. and Linda Frahm

*Additional reporting by **Carrie Myers, M.S. and Linda Frahm***

Explore more:

Healthy Recipes

Soup

Was this page helpful?



